



Big ones, little ones, and some in between. We tested consumer laptops from Acer, Apple, Asus, Dell, HP, Lenovo, MSI, Sony and Toshiba to give you the lowdown on some of the most exciting notebooks available in the market at every budget

Haute or Not?

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It's an important year for laptops, the torchbearers of traditional PCs. Globally, laptops are out-selling desktop PCs for close to a year now. But even laptops are facing increasing competition. They can't catch a break from the ceaseless assault of these new kids on the block – tablets and smartphones.

While more of us prefer buying laptops over desktops as our primary computer, even more of that number are

choosing to invest their money in a high-end smartphone or tablet instead, and that number is rising. PC sales are down as a result, even though from a hardware and performance perspective, laptops are extending the boundaries every single year. They are no longer hot or desirable anymore.

This has had an interesting effect on laptop manufacturers. Aware of the impact tablets and smartphones are having on laptop sales, manufacturers are adopting the popular adage “if you can't beat them, join them,” in their bid to rekindle every-

one's interest in laptops once again. As a result, the market is going to be flooded with ultrabooks – sexy, thin and lightweight laptops that don't compromise on processing power and overall performance.

In this comparative analysis of popular consumer laptops found in the market, we have featured four of the five available ultrabooks in India here – we missed out on the Samsung ultrabook as it launched late last month, there just wasn't enough time. This number is only going to rise as we approach the end of the year. Hopefully, this will

stem the tide of tablets and smartphones a bit and make us fall in love with laptops all over again.

In this article, we've managed to test twenty consumer laptops that make up a sizable chunk of the market.

There's one for every budget (between ₹28,000 to ₹1,00,000) and user type – whether you're a cash-strapped college student barely making ends meet or someone who wants a mobile, portable, and powerful home entertainment system.

We hope this gives you, our reader, a good indication of the